

DeepThinkTrader — Status Report

Date: 2026-05-29 **Scope:** Trading bot health check + Seeking Alpha email pipeline repair

Summary

The bot itself was healthy and running the whole time, but it had been operating with **no Seeking Alpha signal for ~3 weeks**. The SA email sync that feeds the bot died on May 1 and failed silently every hour since. We found it, fixed the root cause, backfilled 336 missed emails, and verified the bot now ingests them.

Bot health (5/28 and 5/29)

Both checks came back green:

- **Bot process** — alive, respawning cleanly under launchd, running `main.py` on the dedicated venv (`~/venvs/deepthinktrader/`). No crash errors.
- **Dashboard** — up at `http://localhost:8501`.
- **Cycle activity** — running on schedule, last LLM calls at each market close.

The only caveat at the time: both paper portfolios (`main`, `penny`) are net-negative on Sharpe/Sortino/Avg-R, and the penny book shows a clearly broken `Max DD 1243%` metric (calculation bug, not a real loss). Neither was today's focus.

The SA sync outage

The Seeking Alpha IMAP sync (`com.britteandtom.sa-sync`, runs `sync_sa_imap.py`) had stopped working on **May 1**. The launchd job reported exit code `78` (`EX_CONFIG`) on every hourly attempt and produced no output — a silent failure.

Last successful run: `May 1, 10:50 AM` ("6 SA emails synced"). Nothing after that.

Root cause

The job's `StandardOutPath` and `StandardErrorPath` both pointed into:

```
/Users/rebelhawk/Documents/Claude/logs/sa_imap_sync_launchd.log
```

macOS (25.4+) blocks launchd from opening child-process stdio inside `~/Documents` under TCC privacy protection. The job failed at config time, before the Python script ever ran. A macOS update around early May flipped this on, which lines up with the May 1 death date. This is a known failure mode that has bitten other launchd jobs in this setup.

Fix applied

1. Repointed both log paths out of `~/Documents` to `~/Library/Logs/sa_imap_sync_launchd.log`.
2. Backed up the original plist (`.bak.20260529`).
3. Reloaded the job — status went from `78` to `0`.
4. Triggered an immediate run.

Backfill

The triggered run cleared the entire 28-day gap: **336 SA emails synced** (May 1 → May 29, including pre-market items from this morning). They landed in `TKSabrinaIncVault/Email/SA/` as dated `.md` files.

Verification — did the bot actually pick them up?

This is where it mattered most. The bot reads SA emails in **vault-scan mode** (`ObsidianSeekingAlpha`), not Gmail mode — and that scanner only loads files dated within the last **7 days**. With the sync dead, the bot had zero in-window files.

Before (every cycle, 01:38 → 06:39 today):

```
Found 0 Seeking Alpha emails in Obsidian (last 7 days)
```

After backfill — running the bot's exact scanner path:

```
Found 298 Seeking Alpha emails in Obsidian (last 7 days)
Seeking Alpha scan: 313 tickers, 577 mentions from 298 emails
```

The bot went from 0 to 298 emails / 313 tickers of SA signal. Its next cycle picks this up automatically (the 30-minute scanner cache had already expired).

Impact

For roughly three weeks the bot was making decisions with no Seeking Alpha input at all — one of its `very_high / high` priority news sources was simply empty. That's now restored.

Why it kept happening silently

Two compounding factors: the `launchd` failure produced no log (it couldn't open the log file), and the bot's "0 emails found" was an INFO line, not a warning — nothing surfaced it.

Follow-ups (optional, not done)

- **Put the bot on Gmail mode** to remove the vault-file dependency entirely: set `SABRINA_API_KEY` in the bot's env. The code already prefers Gmail when that key is present.
- **Fix the penny portfolio** `Max DD 1243%` calculation bug in the snapshot.
- **Investigate net-negative Avg-R** on both portfolios if performance is a concern.

Ongoing schedule: the SA sync now runs hourly and logs cleanly to `~/Library/Logs/`.